RAM DASS KATARI

1911–1983



Into the deep end

Vice Admiral Ram Dass Katari was a naval officer who served as the first Indian Chief of the Naval Staff. On the eve of World War II, Katari, like many other trained sailors, applied to join the Royal Indian Naval Volunteer Reserve. He served both at sea and on shore in several capacities, including sweeping for naval mines, transporting men and ships, and training men in anti-submarine manoeuvres. By the end of World War II, Katari was an experienced officer who had proved his worth. He was subsequently accepted into the Royal Indian Navy as a lieutenant commander.